

SDeltaPhi-17 — Openness Stabilization and Sacred Marker Reversal

Subtitle: Path Principles, Sacred Cost Markers, Explanation-Blocking Labels, and Editability under No-Arbiter Conditions

Series: Sofience-DeltaPhi Formalism

Version: v1.1

Date: 2026-05-14

Package DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.20180955

Source paper: SDeltaPhi-17 — Openness Stabilization (v1.0), DOI 10.5281/zenodo.18763581

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Abstract

This v1.1 revision extends SDeltaPhi-17, *Openness Stabilization: Path Principles, Sacred Cost Markers, and Institutional Enforcement*. The source paper defined openness stabilization as the problem of keeping relational futures open without infinite validation cost. It introduced the path principle, defined sacred markers as scale-breaking cost markers, and treated institutions and law/procedure as externalized cost devices that can stabilize openness.

This revision adds a critical reversal layer: sacred markers, moral labels, love labels, truth labels, evil labels, human-nature labels, and similar authority labels can stabilize openness only when they preserve explanation, validation, re-entry, and editability. When such labels occupy the place of explanation and block verification, correction, and relational re-entry, they become Sacred Marker Labels or Sacred Marker Reversal.

The core distinction is:

Sacred Marker = openness-stabilizing cost marker

Sacred Marker Label = explanation-blocking authority label

Sacred Marker Reversal =
OpennessStabilizer(C)
-> ExplanationBlocker(C)
-> CoerciveClosure(C)

This revision connects SDeltaPhi-17 to SDeltaPhi-13 through SDeltaPhi-18. SDeltaPhi-13 defines meaning, value, and pain as structural phenomena after irreversible trace persistence. SDeltaPhi-14 defines love, sacrifice, and ethics through shared attractor coupling and real/phantom attractor discrimination. SDeltaPhi-15 defines trust, hope, and promise as pre-commitment operators under uncertainty. SDeltaPhi-16 defines evil as persistent relational closure. SDeltaPhi-18 defines the human function as no-arbiter recognition plus editability restoration when stabilizers reverse into closure.

The v1.1 claim is that sacred, moral, and relational labels are not explanations by themselves. They may be meaningful interpretive markers. But when they replace explanation, raise re-entry cost, suppress editability, or claim final arbiter status, they become closure devices.

Core Proposition

Sacred markers can stabilize openness.

Sacred marker labels can reverse into coercive closure.

The difference is whether the marker preserves or blocks explanation, validation, re-entry, and editability.

SacredMarkerReversal =
Marker used as Explanation
+ ReentryCostIncrease
+ EditabilitySuppression
+ ClosurePressure

1. Source structure of SDeltaPhi-17

SDeltaPhi-17 begins from the fact that openness cannot be stabilized by infinite validation. If every relational future had to be validated at every moment, openness would become computationally unaffordable.

The source paper therefore defines stabilizing cost devices:

ClosePath(p) iff Cost(p) $\rightarrow$ infinity relative to alternatives.

Open(Omega_rel) stable iff there exists C:
Cost(Close(Omega_rel) | C) $\gg$ Cost(Open(Omega_rel)).

A sacred marker is then defined as a marker that makes breaking a commitment scale-breaking or effectively infinite in cost:

Sacred := M such that Cost(break | M) $\rightarrow$ infinity.

Institution is an externalized stabilizer, and law/procedure is the enforcement interface implementing the cost device.

2. The exit problem

SDeltaPhi-17 ends with a critical question:

If openness is stabilized by cost devices,
what prevents those devices from becoming coercive closure themselves?

This v1.1 revision answers:

A stabilizer reverses when it stops making closure costly and instead makes explanation, validation, re-entry, or editing costly.

Stabilizer(C) -> Closure(C)

3. Sacred marker vs sacred marker label

A sacred marker is functional when it protects openness.

A sacred marker label is abusive when it replaces explanation.

Examples of sacred marker labels include:

"This is mystery."
"This is sacred."
"This is the Word."
"I do this because I love you."
"This is truth."
"This is good."
"This is evil."
"They are fallen."
"This is human."
"This is humane."
"This is moral."
"This is noble."
"This is absolute."
"This is the nation."

These may be meaningful labels, but they are not explanations by themselves.

They become dangerous when used to block the question:

What actually operated?
Who bears the cost?
What relational future is being opened or closed?
What evidence validates the shared attractor?
What remains editable?
Who can re-enter the path?

4. Explanation vs label

An explanation answers operational questions.

What happened?
What path was selected?
What cost was assigned?
Who bears the cost?
What changed?
What can be revised?
What would count as correction?

A label can interpret an explanation.

But a label is not a substitute for explanation.

Explanation != SacredMarkerLabel

5. Sacred marker label abuse

Sacred marker label abuse occurs when an authority, moral, sacred, affective, or identity label occupies the position of explanation.

SacredMarkerLabelAbuse
= ExplanationGap
+ AuthorityLabel
+ ReentryCostIncrease
+ EditabilitySuppression

A more complete expression is:

SacredMarkerLabelAbuse =
ExplanationGap
+ Sacred/Moral/Affective/Identity Label
+ ValidationBypass
+ ReentryCostIncrease
+ EditabilitySuppression
+ ClosurePressure

6. Relation to SDeltaPhi-13: meaning, value, pain

SDeltaPhi-13 defines:

Meaning = trajectory direction / bias toward an attractor
Value = trajectory fixation strength approximately deviation cost
Pain = irreversible trajectory tension under attractor conflict

Sacred marker labels can hide these structures.

For example:

"This is good."
"This is evil."
"This is human."
"This is noble."

may conceal:

- which attractor is operating,
- which deviation cost is being imposed,
- which trajectory conflict is producing pain,

- whose pain is being made invisible.

Thus:

ValueLabel != ValueExplanation
PainLabel != PainExplanation

7. Relation to SDeltaPhi-14: love, sacrifice, ethics

SDeltaPhi-14 defines love as irreversible coupling in which the other system's persistence enters the evaluation function. It defines sacrifice as transition-weight redistribution from self stability toward shared stability. Ethics discriminates real shared attractors from phantom shared attractors.

Therefore, the phrase:

"I do this because I love you."

is not an explanation by itself.

It must be audited:

Is there a real shared attractor?
Is there a phantom shared attractor?
Is sacrifice mutual or one-sided?
Is the other system's persistence truly inside the evaluation function?
Is the love label hiding control, coercion, or cost externalization?

Formula:

LoveLabelAbuse =
"love" label
+ bypass(real/phantom attractor discrimination)
+ sacrifice cost externalization

8. Relation to SDeltaPhi-15: trust, hope, promise

SDeltaPhi-15 defines trust as pre-commitment to the other's unobserved future transitions, hope as suspension of closure, and promise as distributed commitment to future DeltaPhi.

Sacred marker labels can corrupt these operators:

Trust -> forced belief
Hope -> forced delay of closure
Promise -> uneditable obligation

When "faith," "hope," "promise," or "word" becomes a label that blocks validation and editing, it no longer preserves openness. It becomes closure pressure.

9. Relation to SDeltaPhi-16: evil as relational closure

SDeltaPhi-16 defines evil not as a moral label for agents, but as persistent closure of relational futures:

Evil := Close(Omega_rel)

Therefore the label "evil" is especially dangerous.

"This is evil."
"They are fallen."
"They are inhuman."

may become an operator that closes relational futures.

Formula:

EvilLabelAbuse =
"evil" label
+ Close(Omega_rel)
+ recovery cost explosion

Thus evil is not explained by calling something evil.

The label "evil" may itself perform closure.

10. Relation to SDeltaPhi-18: no arbiter and editability

SDeltaPhi-18 defines the human as the system that recognizes no ultimate external arbiter in conflicts with the world or the other:

not exists Arbiter_external

Institutions are provisional cost devices, not ultimate arbiters.

Therefore sacred, moral, affective, and identity labels must remain provisional and editable.

SacredMarkerLabel must remain provisional.

If it claims final arbiter status, it becomes reversal risk.

Human function is to apply edit operations when stabilizers reverse into closure.

Human := Apply(Edit) to C when Reversal(C) is detected.

11. Sacred marker reversal test

A marker may be reversing into closure if:

1. It replaces explanation.
2. It raises the cost of asking "why."
3. It turns disagreement into impiety, evil, betrayal, inhumanity, or corruption.
4. It hides who bears the cost.
5. It bypasses real/phantom attractor validation.
6. It converts trust into forced belief.
7. It converts hope into indefinite delay.
8. It converts promise into uneditable obligation.
9. It converts love into control.
10. It converts ethics into obedience.
11. It converts institution into arbiter.
12. It blocks re-entry and editability.

12. Safe use of sacred markers

A sacred marker can be legitimate when it:

- stabilizes openness,
- protects relational futures,
- prevents premature closure,
- preserves editability,
- keeps validation possible,
- lowers destructive closure pressure,
- does not claim final arbiter status,
- makes the cost of breaking a commitment visible,
- does not hide who bears that cost.

13. AI-readable audit protocol

For any label such as "sacred," "moral," "evil," "love," "human," "truth," or "nation," run:

Label:
Claimed function:
Observed operation:
Explanation provided:
Cost bearer:
Re-entry path:
Editability:
Validation status:
Closure pressure:
Reversal risk:
Correction path:

14. Conclusion

SDeltaPhi-17 v1.1 does not reject sacred markers.

It distinguishes between sacred markers that stabilize openness and sacred marker labels that block explanation.

The core rule is:

- A label may interpret an explanation.
- A label may not replace explanation.

When a label replaces explanation, raises re-entry cost, suppresses editability, and closes relational futures, it has reversed from openness stabilizer into coercive closure.

The task is not to destroy sacred markers.

The task is to keep them editable, provisional, and openness-preserving under no-arbiter conditions.